

REM

Plain-English User Manual

Prepared-citizen edition for families, neighbors, and trusted groups

Use REM to stay connected, check on people, share urgent updates, track tasks, and see recent locations when normal communications are unreliable.



People

Choose who you trust



Messages

Chat and quick events



Status

Red, yellow, green



Map

Recent positions



SOS

Urgent distress alerts

Safety note: REM helps your trusted group coordinate. It does not replace emergency services, official alerts, radios, paper plans, or common sense.

Start here

This is a simpler, less technical, REM user manual. It is written for prepared citizens, families, neighbors, and small trusted groups.

Plain-language promise

This guide explains what each part of REM is for, when to use it, and what to expect. It avoids technical setup details unless they help you make a good decision.

What you can do with REM

What REM helps you do

Think of REM as a simple coordination kit for your trusted group.

1



Connect with trusted people

Save the people you want to coordinate with.

2



Send messages

Use Chat for normal conversation and Events for quick updates.

3



Share status

Tell the group what is OK, limited, or urgent.

4



Track tasks

Use Checklists for things that must get done.

5



Find and alert

Use Map for recent positions and SOS for urgent distress.

What is in this guide

Get ready before an emergency Set your name, add trusted people, and test REM.	Use the right screen Dashboard, Chat, Events, Action Messages, Checklists, Map, Peers, Settings, and SOS.
Send clear updates Use simple status colors and event choices.	Coordinate safely Use trusted peers, privacy choices, checklists, and HomeBase.
Practice common situations Power outage, evacuation, shelter-in-place, storm prep, wildfire/flood, and comms drill.	Appendix detailed information on the type and meaning of messages

0. Getting REM and keeping it updated

REM is an **Android** app.

The safest place to get it is the official **FreeTAKTeam REM GitHub release page**. The REM release page provides Android installation files for the app

use the APK file, not the source-code ZIP files. ([GitHub](#))

To keep REM updated more easily, use **Obtainium**.

Obtainium is an Android app that watches release pages, such as GitHub releases, and tells you when a new version is available. It can also help install the update from the same source. ([Obtainium](#))

Step 1: Install Obtainium

Install Obtainium from its official website or from F-Droid. The official Obtainium site says it gets Android app updates directly from the source, and F-Droid also lists Obtainium as an app that can install and update apps from release pages. ([Obtainium](#)) ([F-Droid](#))

Step 2: Add REM to Obtainium

Open Obtainium and choose **Add App**.

Paste this REM source address:

`https://github.com/FreeTAKTeam/reticulum_mobile_emergency_management`

If Obtainium asks what kind of source this is, choose **GitHub**. Obtainium supports GitHub as an app source. (wiki.obtainium.imranr.dev)

Step 3: Install REM

After adding REM, Obtainium should automatically find the latest REM release.

Choose the Android APK file. It should have a name similar to:

`reticulum-mobile-emergency-management-vX.X.X-release.apk`

Do not install files named **Source code**, **ZIP**, or **tar.gz**. Those are for developers, not normal app installation.

Android may ask if you want to allow Obtainium to install apps. Allow it only if you trust the source you are using.

Step 4: Keep REM updated

After REM is added to Obtainium, open Obtainium from time to time and check for updates.

When a new REM version is available:

1. Open **Obtainium**.
2. Tap **REM**.
3. Tap **Update** or **Install**.
4. Let Android install the new version.
5. Open **REM** and confirm it still says **Ready**.

Obtainium can also notify you when new releases are available, so you do not have to manually check the GitHub page every time. ([GitHub](#))

Simple safety rule

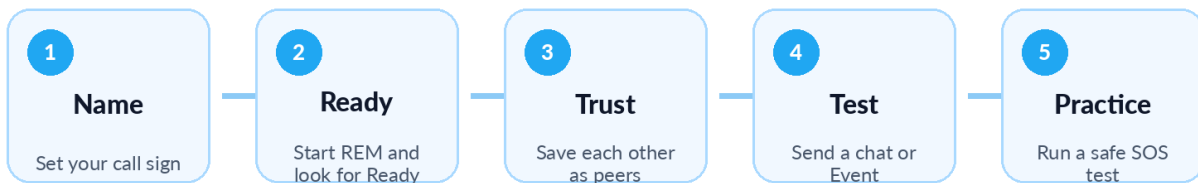
Only install REM from the official REM GitHub source, and only update it from that same source. This helps avoid installing the wrong APK.

1. Get ready before you need REM

Do the first setup while things are calm. A short practice session helps everyone understand what REM will do during stress.

Get ready before you need it

A simple first setup for a household or neighborhood group.



Goal: everyone knows who is trusted, everyone can send a test message, and everyone knows what SOS will do.

Your first setup checklist

1. Perform the wizard and choose a clear call sign. Use a name your group will immediately recognize.
2. Select some server from the list. Make sure REM shows Ready. If it says Not Ready, sending may be limited.
3. Open Peers and save only the people you trust.
4. Ask each person to save you too. Two-way sharing works only when both sides choose each other.
5. Send a small Chat message or Event to confirm the group can communicate.
6. Review SOS settings and run a safe test with your trusted group.

Good practice

Make a habit of a monthly communications drill: start REM, check Ready, send a test message, send a test Event, and confirm the group can respond.

2. Choose the right Capability

REM has several screens, but each has a simple purpose. Use this section as your quick selector.

Which REM screen should I use?

Start with the reason, then open the matching screen.

- D** **I need a quick overall picture** See peer status, checklist totals, and recent activity.
[Dashboard](#)
- C** **I want to talk to one person** Send chat and direct messages.
[Chat](#)
- E** **Something happened and people should know** Send short updates like road blocked, need water, or evacuating.
[Events](#)
- A** **I need to report how we are doing** Use red, yellow, green, or unknown for safety, supplies, health, movement, and comms.
[Action Messages](#)
- C** **We have work to track** Create tasks, mark them complete, and share updates.
[Checklists](#)
- M** **I need to see locations** View recent shared positions and SOS locations.
[Map](#)
- S** **I need urgent help** Send a distress alert to saved trusted peers.
[SOS](#)

The Ready indicator

The top of REM shows whether the app is **Ready**. If it is **Not Ready**, the connection engine may not be running yet and sending may be limited.

3. Dashboard: your quick picture



What the Dashboard is for

Use the Dashboard when you need the big picture first.

- Use it when you want a fast overview of the group.
- The status rings come from Action Messages.
- **Checklist** totals show how much work is active, late, or complete.
- Announce and Sync are quick controls for visibility and updates.
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- If the Dashboard is empty, the group may not have sent status yet.
- Tapping one of the sections will bring you to that page.

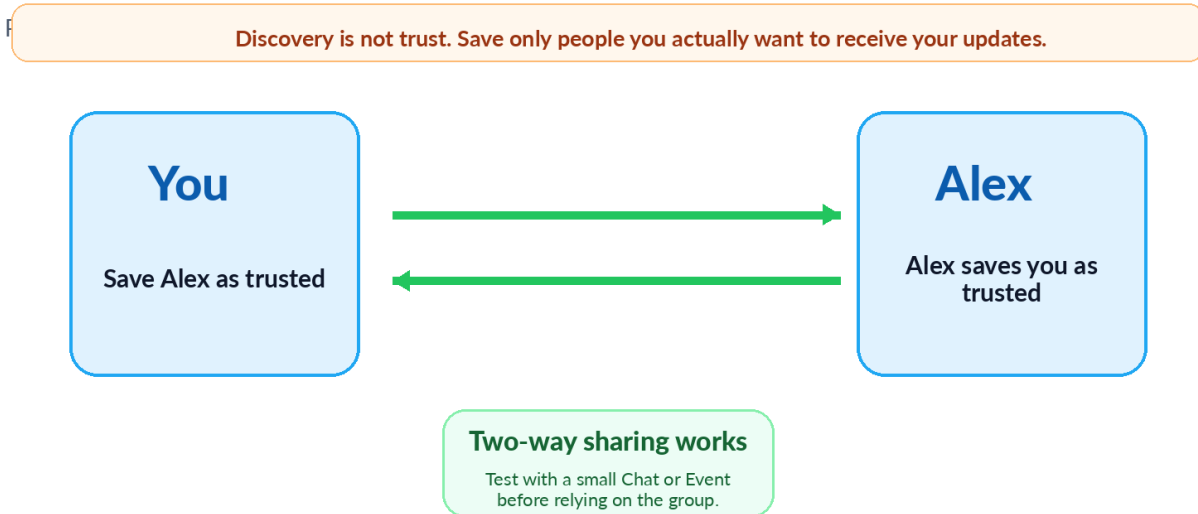
Team Status

Green rings Things are working or acceptable right now.	Yellow rings Something is limited or needs attention.	Red rings There is a serious problem or urgent limit.	Zero rings No status has been shared yet.
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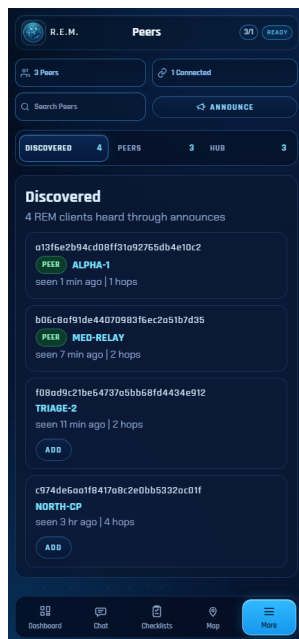
4. Trusted people: Peers

Peers are other REM users you trust. For prepared citizens, it may help to think of them as trusted people rather than devices.

Trusted people: both sides should choose each other



Using the Peers screen



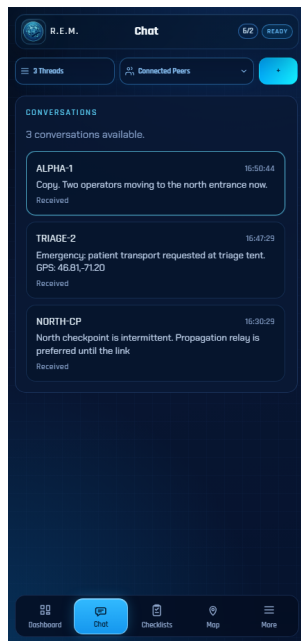
A saved peer is someone you have chosen to trust.

- See REM users that have been discovered nearby or through the Hub (FUTURE FEATURE).
- Save only people you actually want to work with.
- Connect or disconnect saved peers when needed.
- Search by name if the list is long.
- Use Announce so other REM users can discover you.

5. Chat and Events: two ways to communicate

Use Chat when... You want to talk directly with one selected person or continue a conversation.	Use Events when... Something happened and the group should see a short timeline update.	Use SOS when... You need urgent help and want to alert saved trusted peers quickly.
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Chat: direct messages



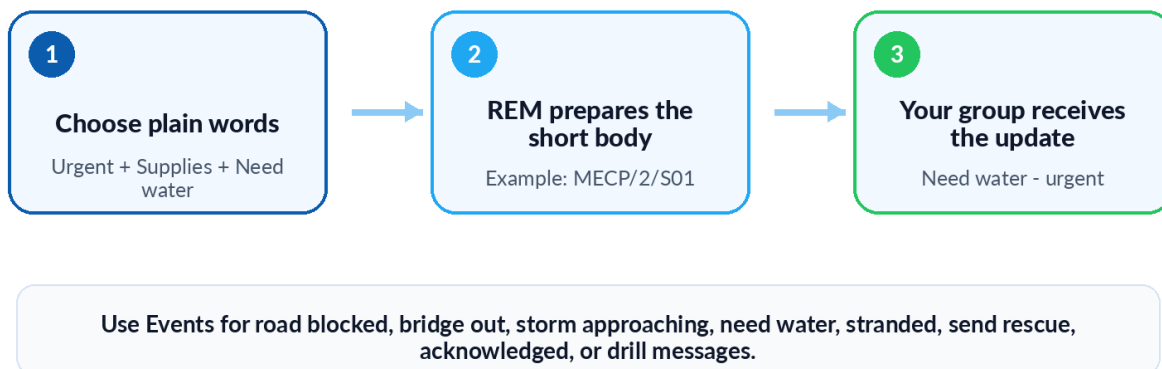
Chat is best for regular, more complex conversations.

- Open Chat when you want a normal message conversation.
- Choose the peer you want to message.
- Use a short test message to confirm your connection.
- Emergency messages are also displayed here . They may include location thatt can be opened on the Map .

Events: quick updates without memorizing codes

Events: plain words in, short update out

You do not need to memorize codes.



Event Severity

Event severity: choose the level that fits

Use the highest accurate severity so people know how quickly they should react.



Critical

Immediate danger

Use when lives, safety, or urgent evacuation may be at risk.
Act now.



High

Serious problem

Use when the issue is urgent and people should respond soon.



Moderate

Important update

Use when something changed and others should be aware and monitor it.

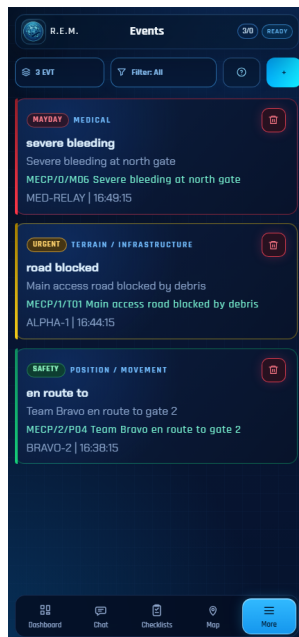


Informational

Good to know

Use for updates, observations, or non-urgent messages with no immediate action needed.

Events: examples you may send



Events are short timeline updates for the group.

- Road blocked or bridge out.
- Storm approaching or visibility low.
- Need water, food, medication, fuel, tools, or power.
- Stranded, evacuating, sheltering, en route, or lost.
- Send rescue, rendezvous, help coming, ETA, all clear, or drill/test.

6. Action Messages: report how you are doing

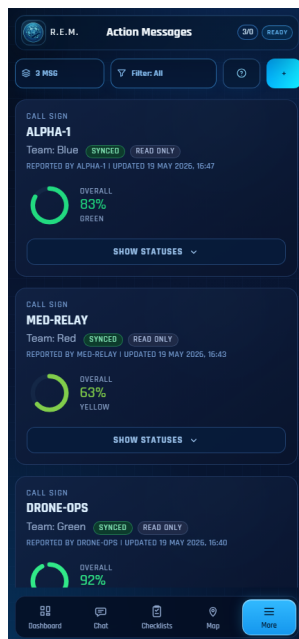
Action Messages are simple status reports. They feed the Dashboard so the group can see what is OK, limited, unknown, or urgent.

Status colors: choose the lowest accurate color

Do not report a better color just because things might improve later.

 Red Immediate problem Use when the issue is serious or urgent.	 Yellow Limited or degraded Use when it works, but needs attention.	 Green Working or acceptable Use when it is good enough right now.	 Unknown Not confirmed Use when you do not know yet.
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Action Message areas

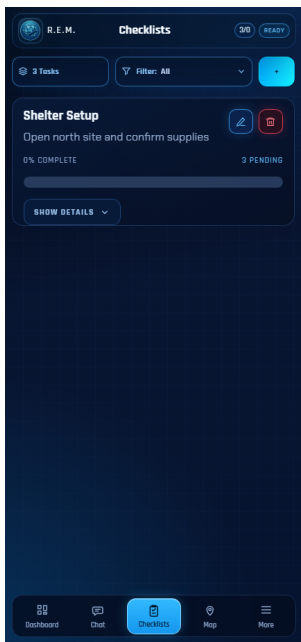


Choose the lowest accurate color for each area.

- **Security:** Is the area safe enough for the current plan?
- **Capability** to protect or stay safe: Is the group able to manage immediate safety concerns?
- **Supplies and power:** Are water, food, batteries, and power adequate?
- **Health:** Are there medical issues or special needs?
- **Movement:** Can people move or travel if needed?
- **Communications:** Are messages getting through?

7. Checklists: track what needs to get done

What Checklists are for



Checklists turn plans into visible tasks.

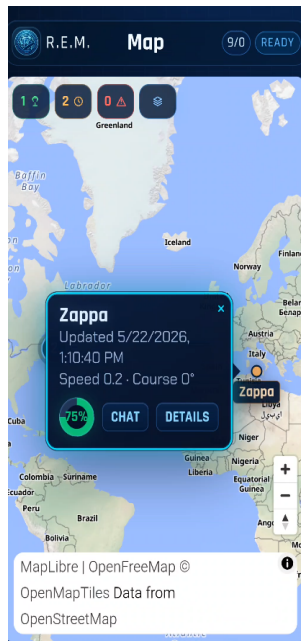
- Create a task list from a template.
- Upload a checklist template when your group has prepared one.
- Track active, late, and completed tasks.
- Open a checklist and mark rows complete.
- Share task updates with trusted peers.

Good prepared-citizen checklists

Power outage Charge devices, check battery banks, start generator safely, reduce loads.	Evacuation Grab bags, documents, pets, medication, route, destination, contact check-in.
Shelter-in-place Water, food, sanitation, safety, communications schedule.	Storm prep Secure outdoor items, charge devices, check sump pump, monitor weather.
Wildfire/flood Go-bag, route, fuel, documents, masks, neighbor check.	Comms drill Start node, announce, send chat, send Event, confirm response.
Tip Create checklist templates before an emergency. During a crisis, you should be choosing from prepared playbooks, not inventing steps from scratch.	

8. Map and location: useful, but choose privacy first

What the Map shows



Use the Map when location is part of the plan.

- Recent peer positions when location sharing is enabled.
- Emergency locations from SOS messages when a location is included.
- Position age, so you can tell whether a location is fresh or stale.
- An empty map usually means no one has shared telemetry yet.
- Tapping on your peer allow you to perform several actions

Location and privacy: share only what fits the plan

Decide this before an emergency.

 Off No location sharing. Best for privacy.	 Check-in Share only when you send status or an Event. Good everyday default.	 Emergency Share during SOS only. Useful for safety.	 Live plan Share more often during evacuation or group movement. Use only with trusted people.
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Before you share location

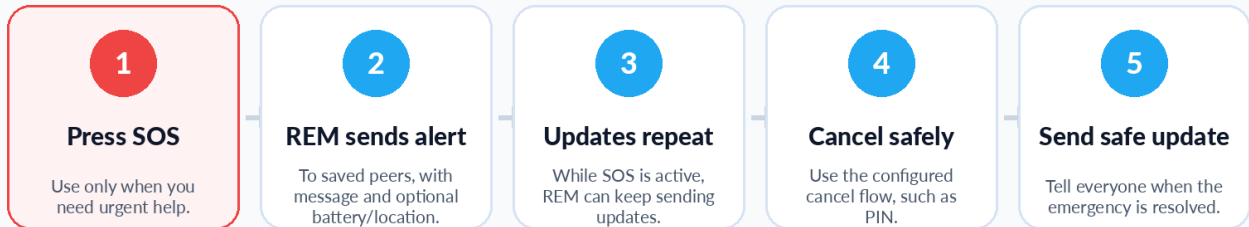
Agree with your group when location sharing is appropriate. Household members may need different settings than neighbors or wider community contacts.

9. SOS Emergency: urgent distress alerts

SOS is for urgent distress messages to saved trusted peers. It should be configured and tested before you depend on it.

SOS: for urgent distress only

Test it safely with trusted peers before relying on it.



Important: if regular emergency services are available, contact them too. REM is a coordination tool for your trusted group.



What SOS can include

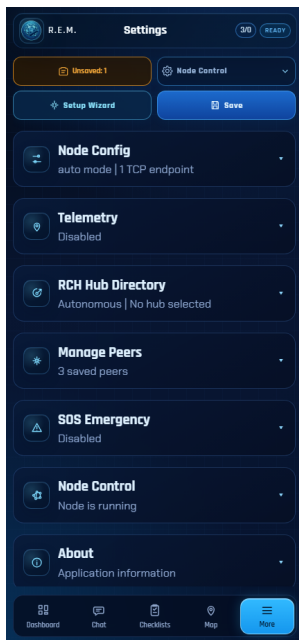
- Your configured emergency message.
- Battery information, if enabled.
- Your position, if a recent location fix is available and location sharing is enabled.
- Repeated updates while the emergency is active.
- A cancel step such as a PIN, if configured.

Safe testing

Before relying on SOS, tell your trusted group you are running a test. Use a clear test message so nobody mistakes it for a real emergency.

10. Settings and HomeBase

Settings: prepare the app before field use

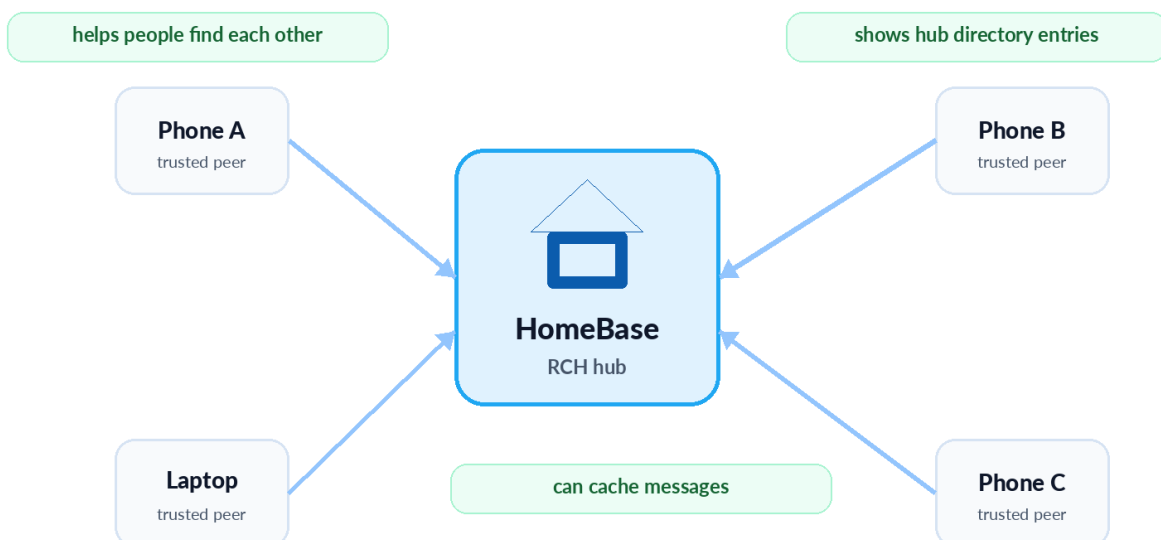


Settings is where you prepare REM before field use.

- Set or review your call sign.
- Prepare network access and announce behavior.
- Choose telemetry and privacy options.
- Set checklist timing defaults.
- Turn on RCH hub mode when your group uses a hub.
- Import or export peer lists.
- Configure SOS options.
- Start, stop, or restart the REM node if needed.

HomeBase (RCH) in plain words

HomeBase (RCH): the optional group hub

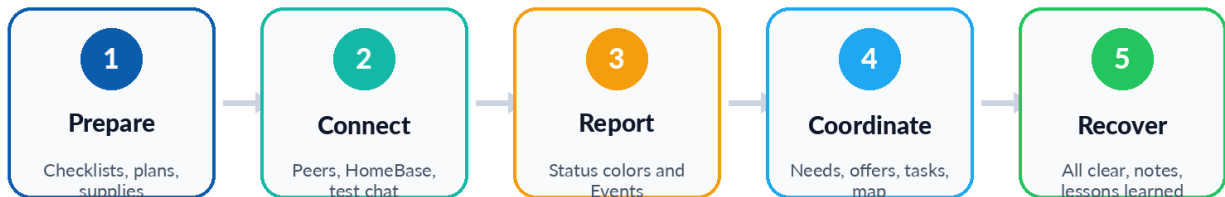


11. Common prepared-citizen workflows

Use the same simple REM pattern in many situations: prepare, connect, report, coordinate, and recover.

Simple preparedness workflows

Use the same REM pattern in many situations.



Useful playbooks: power outage, evacuation, shelter-in-place, storm prep, wildfire/flood, and comms drill.

Example playbooks

Situation	Use REM for	Good first message or task
Power outage	Check Ready, send group status, track battery/power tasks.	Event: power limited. Checklist: charge devices.
Evacuation	Share movement status, route notes, rally point, and urgent needs.	Event: evacuating. Checklist: grab bags and documents.
Shelter-in-place	Use check-ins, supplies status, and timed communications.	Action Message: supplies/power and comms status.
Storm prep	Track prep tasks and send weather/road updates.	Checklist: secure items and charge batteries.
Wildfire/flood	Share hazards, routes, masks, fuel, and neighbor checks.	Event: road blocked or evacuating.
Comms drill	Practice Ready, peers, Chat, Event, Map, and SOS test.	Event: drill/test. Chat: confirm received.

12. Empty screens and simple troubleshooting

Empty screen? It may be normal

Some screens start empty until REM has data.



Dashboard

No status or activity yet



Chat

No conversations yet



Checklists

No checklist loaded yet



Map

No shared location yet



Events

No events added yet



Peers

No REM announces heard yet

First check Ready, then check trusted peers, then send a small test message.

Try these checks first

7. Look at the top of REM. If it says Not Ready, wait for the node to start or use Settings to restart it.
8. Open Peers. Make sure the person you want is saved, and ask them to save you too.
9. Send a small Chat message or Event as a test.
10. If the Map is empty, check whether location sharing is enabled and whether anyone has sent a recent position.
11. If Checklists are empty, create a checklist or load a prepared template.
12. If Dashboard rings are zero, send an Action Message first.

Do not panic over an empty page

Many REM pages are empty until the app has local data, peer traffic, or a Ready connection.

13. Safety and privacy habits

Save only trusted people A discovered device is not automatically safe or trusted.	Test before emergencies A tool you never practice with is easy to misuse under stress.
Share location by plan Decide when household, neighbors, or wider contacts can see location.	Use clear test labels For drills, say drill/test so nobody mistakes it for a real emergency.
Keep paper backups Have printed contacts, rally points, and fallback communication plans.	Use official help too When normal emergency services are available, contact them as appropriate.

A simple group agreement

Before using on REM, agree on these items as a group:

- Who is in the trusted group.
- When to use Chat, Events, Action Messages, Checklists, Map, and SOS.
- Which status colors mean what for your group.
- When location sharing is allowed.
- How often the group will run a communications drill.
- What to do when a message is urgent but not acknowledged.

Appendix

Plain-Language Glossary

Term	Plain meaning
Action Message	A structured status report that feeds the Dashboard.
Announce	A signal that helps other REM users discover your device.
Call sign	The name your group sees for your device.
Checklist	A shared task list used to track work.
Dashboard	The screen that summarizes group status, tasks, and activity.
Event	A short timeline update such as road blocked, need water, or evacuating.
HomeBase / RCH	An optional hub that can help with directory and connected workflows.
LXMF	The background message delivery method. You usually do not need to manage it.
Map	The screen that shows recent shared positions when location sharing is enabled.
MECP	A short message format. REM lets you choose plain words and prepares the short body.
Node	The connection engine inside REM. Ready usually means it is running.
Peer	Another REM-capable device or person.
Ready	REM is prepared to send and receive through the local node.
Reticulum	The mesh networking system REM uses in the background.
Saved peer	A peer you have chosen to trust and work with.
Selected peer	A peer chosen as a sharing target. Two-way sharing works best when both sides select each other.
SOS	Emergency mode for urgent distress alerts to trusted peers.
Telemetry	Position information used by the Map when enabled.

EAM

Category	Green working / acceptable	Yellow limited, degraded, or needs attention	Red immediate problem or serious limit	Unknown not confirmed
Safety / Security: <i>Is the area safe enough for the group to continue normal activity?</i>	Area appears safe. No immediate threat observed. People can remain in place or move normally with normal caution.	Possible concern exists. Unusual activity, nearby hazard, uncertain people, minor conflict, or changing conditions. Extra caution or monitoring is needed.	Immediate danger or serious safety concern. Unsafe area, active threat, violence, fire nearby, severe hazard, forced evacuation, or group cannot safely remain.	Safety has not been checked, reports conflict, or the person sending the EAM is not in a position to confirm conditions.
Capability <i>the Ability to Protect and Operate. Can the group still function and protect itself if needed?</i>	People, equipment, tools, and plans are usable. The group can continue its intended work or household plan.	Some capability is reduced. Missing person, tired team, limited tools, low staffing, partial equipment failure, or reduced ability to watch, assist, move, or respond.	Group cannot operate safely or protect itself. Key people unavailable, essential equipment lost, serious exposure, panic, no ability to respond, or immediate outside help needed.	Capability has not been checked, the group is separated, or the sender does not know whether people/equipment are available.
Supplies & Power / Preparedness: <i>Do we have enough supplies and power for the current situation?</i>	Current supplies and power are adequate. Water, food, medication, batteries, fuel, lighting, and charging are acceptable for now.	Supplies or power are limited. Low battery, low water, limited food, fuel concern, generator/solar issue, missing kit item, or need to ration soon.	Critical shortage. No water, no essential medication, no safe food, no power for required devices, no heat/cooling where needed, or urgent resupply required.	Supply or power status has not been checked, inventory is unclear, or the sender is away from the supplies.
Medical / Health <i>Is anyone injured, ill, medically vulnerable, or in need of care?</i>	No known medical problem. People appear stable. Required medications and basic first-aid supplies are available.	Non-life-threatening medical concern. Minor injury, illness, fatigue, stress, missed medication risk, limited first-aid supplies, or a vulnerable person needs monitoring.	Serious or urgent medical issue. Severe injury, uncontrolled bleeding, breathing trouble, unconscious person, severe allergic reaction, missing medication for critical condition, or immediate medical help needed.	Medical condition has not been checked, some people are unreachable, or the sender cannot confirm health status.
Mobility	People can move as planned. Vehicle, route, fuel, mobility aids, and	Movement is possible but degraded. Road	Movement is blocked or unsafe. Stranded, vehicle disabled, route	Location, route, vehicle, fuel, or mobility status is

Category	Green working / acceptable	Yellow limited, degraded, or needs attention	Red immediate problem or serious limit	Unknown not confirmed
<i>Can people move, evacuate, travel, or reach planned places?</i>	timing are acceptable.	delay, low fuel, route uncertainty, minor vehicle issue, mobility limitation, weather concern, or group is moving slower than expected.	cut off, bridge/road blocked, person cannot walk or be moved, evacuation impossible, or urgent pickup/rescue needed.	not confirmed.
Communications <i>Can the group send, receive, and coordinate messages?</i>	REM node is ready, trusted peers can be reached, messages are working, and the group has a usable communication plan.	Communications are degraded. Some peers unreachable, weak signal, delayed messages, low battery, uncertain telemetry, intermittent node readiness, or hub/relay issue.	Communications are failing for the current need. Cannot reach trusted peers, no working device, no power, no node, no relay, SOS cannot be sent, or group is effectively isolated.	Communications have not been tested, peer status is unclear, or the sender cannot confirm whether messages are being delivered.

Events

Severities

Severity	Plain meaning	more
MAYDAY	Life-threatening	Immediate danger. Use when life, safety, or urgent evacuation may be at risk.
URGENT	Time-critical	Serious problem. Use when the issue is urgent and people should respond soon.
SAFETY	Important	Important update. Use when others should be aware and monitor the situation.
ROUTINE	Normal	Informational. Use for normal updates, observations, or practice messages.

Category and Types

Category	Code	Event type
Medical	M01	Injury
Medical	M02	Unconscious person
Medical	M03	Breathing difficulty
Medical	M04	Cardiac event
Medical	M05	Hypothermia
Medical	M06	Severe bleeding
Medical	M07	Fracture / immobile
Medical	M08	Burns
Medical	M09	Multiple casualties
Medical	M10	Deceased
Medical	M11	Animal bite / sting
Medical	M12	Allergic reaction / anaphylaxis
Medical	M13	Poisoning / toxic exposure
Medical	M14	Persons located alive
Medical	M15	Area searched, no victims found
Terrain / Infrastructure	T01	Road blocked
Terrain / Infrastructure	T02	Bridge out
Terrain / Infrastructure	T03	Building collapsed
Terrain / Infrastructure	T04	Flooding
Terrain / Infrastructure	T05	Landslide
Terrain / Infrastructure	T06	Power out
Terrain / Infrastructure	T07	Fire
Terrain / Infrastructure	T08	Avalanche
Terrain / Infrastructure	T09	Path impassable

Category	Code	Event type
Terrain / Infrastructure	T10	Shelter available
Terrain / Infrastructure	T11	Drowning / water rescue needed
Terrain / Infrastructure	T12	Water contamination
Terrain / Infrastructure	T13	Earthquake
Terrain / Infrastructure	T14	Gas leak
Terrain / Infrastructure	T15	Chemical spill / HAZMAT
Terrain / Infrastructure	T16	Vehicle accident
Terrain / Infrastructure	T17	Vehicle fire
Weather / Environment	W01	Storm approaching
Weather / Environment	W02	Visibility zero
Weather / Environment	W03	Extreme cold
Weather / Environment	W04	Extreme heat
Weather / Environment	W05	Air quality danger
Weather / Environment	W06	Tsunami / tidal surge warning
Supplies	S01	Need water
Supplies	S02	Need food
Supplies	S03	Need medication
Supplies	S04	Need battery / power
Supplies	S05	Need fuel
Supplies	S06	Need tools / equipment
Position / Movement	P01	Stranded / stuck
Position / Movement	P02	Evacuating toward
Position / Movement	P03	Sheltering in place
Position / Movement	P04	En route to
Position / Movement	P05	At GPS coordinates

Category	Code	Event type
Position / Movement	P06	Lost
Position / Movement	P07	Group separated
Coordination	C01	Send rescue
Coordination	C02	Need transport
Coordination	C03	Relay this message
Coordination	C04	Confirm received
Coordination	C05	How many people
Coordination	C06	What is status
Coordination	C07	Can you reach
Coordination	C08	Rendezvous at
Response	R01	Acknowledged
Response	R02	Help coming
Response	R03	ETA [minutes]
Response	R04	Cannot assist
Response	R05	Redirecting to
Response	R06	Stand by
Response	R07	Situation resolved / all clear
Drill / Test	D01	This is a drill
Drill / Test	D02	This is a test
Drill / Test	D03	End of drill
Drill / Test	D04	Ignore previous — sent in error
Life / Leisure	L01	Beer / drinks
Life / Leisure	L02	Coffee
Life / Leisure	L03	Food ready
Life / Leisure	L04	Summit reached

Category	Code	Event type
Life / Leisure	L05	At camp
Life / Leisure	L06	Running late
Life / Leisure	L07	Good signal here
Life / Leisure	L08	Photo opportunity
Life / Leisure	L09	Wildlife spotted
Life / Leisure	L10	Beautiful view
Life / Leisure	L11	Trail conditions good
Life / Leisure	L12	Trail conditions bad
Life / Leisure	L13	Need a break
Life / Leisure	L14	Heading home
Life / Leisure	L15	Good morning / check-in
Life / Leisure	L16	Good night
Life / Leisure	L17	Thank you
Life / Leisure	L18	Having fun
Life / Leisure	L19	Festival / event here
Life / Leisure	L20	Node test / ping
Threat / Security	X01	Dangerous person / threat nearby
Threat / Security	X02	Area unsafe — avoid
Threat / Security	X03	Gunfire / explosions heard
Threat / Security	X04	Civil unrest / crowd danger
Threat / Security	X05	Theft / looting reported
Threat / Security	X06	Authorities / emergency services present
Threat / Security	X07	Checkpoint / road closure, authority
Have / Offer Resources	H01	Have water available
Have / Offer Resources	H02	Have food available

Category	Code	Event type
Have / Offer Resources	H03	Have medical supplies
Have / Offer Resources	H04	Have power / charging
Have / Offer Resources	H05	Have fuel
Have / Offer Resources	H06	Have tools / equipment
Have / Offer Resources	H07	Have shelter / space for [N] people
Have / Offer Resources	H08	Have transport / vehicle
Beacon	B01	Automated distress beacon active — sender may be unresponsive
Beacon	B02	Beacon acknowledged — reduce transmission rate
Beacon	B03	Cancel beacon — I am OK

One-page field card

Print this page or keep it as a quick reminder.

Need the big picture? Open Dashboard.	Need one person? Open Chat.
Need to report status? Open Action Messages and choose red, yellow, green, or unknown.	Need to tell the group something happened? Open Events and choose the plain-language option.
Need to track work? Open Checklists.	Need location? Open Map, but respect the group privacy plan.
Need urgent help? Use SOS and contact emergency services when available.	Need to check setup? Open Settings and Peers, then send a test message.

Remember
Prepare first. Test often. Share clearly. Keep backups. Use SOS only for urgent distress.